

Missing Fleas playtest observer sheet

10-15 minutes, no-rescue session. This sheet tests the game, not the player.

Before the player arrives Player type: ☐ new coder ☐ R/Python user ☐ pair

Device/browser: _____ Start time: _____

Started from: ☐ Windows setup ☐ Mac setup ☐ already-running game

Say only: "Please play the game without help. If you get stuck, say aloud what you expected to happen. I am testing the game, not you, so I will not teach or point things out."

Do not demonstrate code, name a button, or explain Julia while the player is deciding what to do.

Observe the first 10-15 minutes

Moment	What happened?	Time	Exact words, expectation, or question
Open the game	Did they understand what this is and why it is local?		
First minute	Can they state the case question and identify the supplied data/table?		
First move	Can they find the next action and begin without help?		
First Julia run	What code did they expect to run? What did the result mean to them?		
Error or hesitation	What did they think went wrong? Did they use a hint or recovery message?		
Returned evidence	Can they say what Julia did, what it tells the case, and what it does not?		
Navigation	Can they find the next chapter or return to the Case Board?		

Gate checklist - mark observed, not inferred

☐ Within 1 minute, states the question in their own words.

☐ Identifies the relevant named input(s).

☐ Within 3 minutes, makes a first accepted move using on-screen support.

☐ Explains the effect of their code.

☐ Explains the case discovery it enabled.

☐ Recovers from one ordinary error or hesitation without rescue.

☐ Says what remains unknown; does not infer a causal culprit.

☐ Finds the Case Board or next-chapter route.

☐ Says whether they want to continue, and why.

If the player stops or asks for help

Chapter/screen: _____ Expected next step: _____

What they tried: _____

What was missing, confusing, or too much: _____

Did a visible hint, table, label, or recovery message resolve it? ☐ yes ☐ no

Ask only after play 1. What was the mystery asking you to find out? 2. What did your last Julia move do?

3. What did the game help you understand about Julia? 4. What was most confusing? 5. Would you continue, and why?

Observer verdict ☐ pass ☐ revise ☐ unclear

One repair before the next player: _____

Evidence retained (notes or recording location; consent if recorded): _____